

TOOLS AND MATERIALS

Making a quilt does not require a lot of equipment. If you are a beginner, you probably won't need more than needles and threads or a sewing machine, scissors, pins, a ruler or measuring tape, a pencil,

and a thimble. There is, however, an enormous selection of specialized tools that have been designed to make quilting easier.

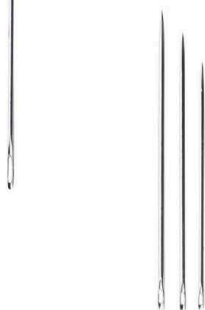
► GENERAL SEWING EQUIPMENT

For quilting you will need a set of hand-sewing needles – both “sharps” and “betweens”. Both types come in several lengths, thicknesses, and eye size. Needles are sized by number: the higher the number,

the finer the needle. Pins are essential for pinning the layers of a quilt together while you work. Always press seams as you go, with an iron or by fingerpressing.

Sharps

“Sharps” are standard hand-sewing needles and are usually used for processes such as tacking, hand piecing, and finishing the edge of binding.

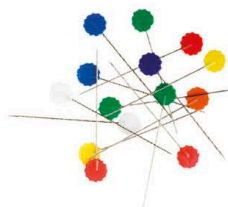


Betweens or quilting needles
Shorter than sharps, these allow quick, even stitching for hand quilting and appliqué.



Iron

It is essential to press seams as you work, so have an iron and ironing board set up in your work area.



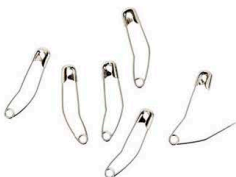
Quilter's pins

Long quilter's pins are useful for holding the layers of a quilt together as you work. Flower-headed pins are easy to pick up.



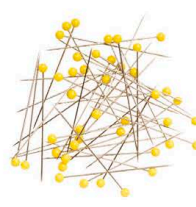
Safety pins

If the layers of the quilt are not too thick, you can use ordinary safety pins to hold them together.



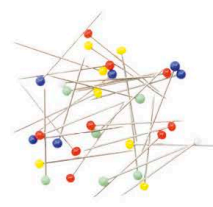
Curved safety pins

These are most commonly used for pin-tacking the layers of a quilt. The curve helps prevent the layers from shifting.



Glass quilter's pins

Glass-headed pins are easy to handle and are not affected by a hot iron. These are extra long for quilting, too.



Glass-headed straight pins

Ordinary dressmaking pins are used to hold pieces together during hand piecing.



Hera

A plastic, blade-like device for creasing a temporary line on the fabric. A small wooden “iron” or chisel can also be used.



Thimble

Made from metal, leather or suede, plastic, or a combination, a thimble protects the middle finger when pushing the needle through the fabric.

Pin cushion

Pin cushions range from traditional emery-powder-filled shapes to magnetic pin-catchers. Magnetic types can interfere with the smooth operation of computerized sewing machines.

